and civilian bureaucrats in the Ministry of Defence, between the defence ministry and finance ministry (on budgetary matters), and between the defence ministry and external affairs ministry (on foreign procurement, military diplomacy, and overseas operations). [10] Over time—and considering also its growing security responsibilities in a broader region amid China's rise and the United States' resource constraints—India will have to increase its expeditionary capabilities, including its ability to conduct amphibious operations, air-to-air refueling, and special forces operations.

National security management has evolved since the creation of a Defence Committee of the Cabinet in 1947. After 1962, India had an Emergency Cabinet Committee which was bureaucratized into a Committee of Secretaries. In 1990, the government of V.P. Singh created the first National Security Council assisted by a Strategic Core Group of military, intelligence chiefs, and secretaries from relevant ministries. A permanent National Security Council was established only in April 1999 after India's nuclear tests, along with an office of the National Security Advisor to coordinate policy. In recent years, the National Security Council Secretariat has expanded to include designated coordinators for cyber security and maritime security. The Cabinet Committee on Security (CCS) remains the primary sanctioning body for defence procurement, law and order, and foreign policy while the national security advisor is the key official advising the prime minister on matters of national security and foreign policy. [11]

Strategic plans and operational readiness are the primary responsibility of the military services themselves. Until recently, the three services have operated relatively autonomously with service chiefs enjoying both staff and command functions. This sufficed in 1971 but was beginning to prove inadequate by the 1990s. For example, the Kargil War of 1999 revealed glaring gaps in communication and operational execution between the Army and Air Force. A series of government advisory committees have recommended a move to joint commands and the separation of staff and command functions. Although India did create a chief of defence staff (CDS) position and made it a secretary in a new Department of Military